

Speaker 1 [00:00:03] Now, first of all, I'm going to read a text to you. As I said earlier, thank you for participating in the interview. As we mentioned in the text we sent, we want to learn more about your views on romantic relationships. I believe your experiences and perspectives will contribute very much to the project. Before we start, is it okay to record this interview for the records? We will only use the recording to take transcription notes.

Speaker 2 [00:00:34] Sure. That's fine.

Speaker 1 [00:00:36] Okay. Also, during the process, I will take notes until then.

Speaker 2 Okay.

Speaker 1 Okay, let's start. So, how old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:45] I'm [21-25] years old.

Speaker 1 [00:00:47] How long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:51] Over [1-5] years.

Speaker 1 [00:00:55] Do you have any children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:57] No.

Speaker 1 [00:00:58] Who do you live with at home?

Speaker 2 [00:01:01] I live with my family.

Speaker 1 [00:01:04] Hmm. What is your main source of income?

Speaker 2 [00:01:09] Currently, I don't have a source of income. My family supports me.

Speaker 1 [00:01:15] How would you like to address your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:01:19] You can call him [Partner's Name] directly.

Speaker 1 [00:01:21] Okay, directly [Partner's Name]. Can you tell me the story of how you met? How did it start?

Speaker 2 [00:01:29] We were friends in the middle school and on [Social Media]. We used to send each other funny videos on social media and reply to each other's stories. We started interacting more that way. It continued like that. Then after the flirting stage, our sevgililik and aşk began.

Speaker 1 [00:01:48] So, you met [1-5] and a half years ago, and your relationship started in that process?

Speaker 2 [00:01:56] Since we were middle school friends, actually, we have known each other since middle school, but our relationship started about [1-5] and a half years ago.

Speaker 1 [00:02:06] How would you evaluate your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:02:13] I think it's good quality. I believe it's a healthy relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:02:18] Hmmm, good quality and healthy. Why do you think so?

Speaker 2 [00:02:23] We respect each other's spaces. We don't invade each other's personal space. Additionally, we respect each other a lot. I think we express our sevgimiz well. I haven't felt any toxic behavior from my perspective.

Speaker 1 [00:02:46] Yes, okay. Can I ask how many romantic relationships you've had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:02:58] Including [Partner's Name], I've had [1-5] relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:03:03] How would you compare the quality of your current relationship with the previous ones?

Speaker 2 [00:03:10] I think it's better and higher quality now than my previous relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:03:14] Why do you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:03:17] In my previous relationship, there were a lot of issues. I felt very worthless and guilty. I didn't think I had done anything wrong, but I felt a lot of pressure. My previous partner didn't have an approach of saying what was bothering him in a nice way. In this relationship, if something bothers us, we can talk about it nicely and try to fix it.

Speaker 1 [00:03:54] What makes this relationship high quality for you?

Speaker 2 [00:04:00] Mutual respect and good communication. Open communication, not passive-aggressive. Additionally, aşk. Showing love varies from person to person. I believe we know each other well and so we understand each other better.

Speaker 1 [00:04:23] So, for you, a relationship with mutual respect and open communication is strong, right?

Speaker 2 [00:04:31] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:04:32] Can you tell me how it is that you have mutual respect or open communication in your relationship? For example, what makes you feel this way?

Speaker 2 [00:04:44] So open communication is more like this. For instance, I might imply something without clearly stating it, and later I explain that I didn't mean it that way. It's important to address these things.

Speaker 1 [00:05:20] What are the most important things for a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:05:26] Sevgi, respect. These are clichés, but good communication, understanding each other well. We are like friends, not just lovers. Honesty, no lying.

Speaker 1 [00:06:03] What is aşk to you?

Speaker 2 [00:06:07] Aşk can be a healthy emotion, an unhealthy emotion or an obsession. But obsession isn't aşk to me. Aşk must include respect and love.

Speaker 1 [00:06:35] How important is aşk in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:06:38] Very important. In a romantic relationship, it's crucial.

Speaker 1 [00:06:44] How do you know your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:06:49] It's a difficult question. Simple gestures like pulling my chair, giving me my coat, or remembering small details. These actions show me that he listens and cares about me.

Speaker 1 [00:07:35] Can you say there are difficult times in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:07:41] Especially during the summer, when school is out, we become long-distance. It's tough not to see each other. Other than that, there haven't been many difficulties.

Speaker 1 [00:08:02] Do you and your partner fight?

Speaker 2 [00:08:06] Yes, but not often.

Speaker 1 [00:08:12] How often do you fight?

Speaker 2 [00:08:15] About once a month. It seems normal to me.

Speaker 1 [00:08:26] What are the fights usually about?

Speaker 2 [00:08:30] It varies. Sometimes we are both stressed, and little things can set us off. But we usually talk it out and resolve things.

Speaker 1 [00:09:11] How do you resolve these fights?

Speaker 2 [00:09:14] We sit and talk about it, acknowledging if we were wrong. We don't like to cover things up because they resurface later.

Speaker 1 [00:09:41] Besides talking, what other ways do you resolve issues?

Speaker 2 [00:09:49] We make small gestures to each other. Even if we haven't fully talked it out, we try to make amends through actions.

Speaker 1 [00:10:14] Do you think this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:10:20] Yes, it's going well. I'm happy.

Speaker 1 [00:10:24] Why do you think that?

Speaker 2 [00:10:28] I can express myself without fear. He understands me, and I feel free to be myself without worrying about judgment.

Speaker 1 [00:11:18] Has this relationship changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:11:22] Yes, I've become more open and communicative. I've learned that talking things out is better.

Speaker 1 [00:11:41] Has your partner changed?

Speaker 2 [00:11:45] Yes, he has matured. He used to be more childlike, but now he's more responsible.

Speaker 1 [00:11:59] Do you think he is the same as before?

Speaker 2 [00:12:05] No, he seems more settled and grounded now.

Speaker 1 [00:12:14] Why do you think so?

Speaker 2 [00:12:17] He used to be more scattered and immature. Now he is more organized and mature.

Speaker 1 [00:12:38] Do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:12:43] Yes, I do.

Speaker 1 [00:12:45] Can you give an example of when you feel safe?

Speaker 2 [00:12:53] Small things like him making sure I'm safe from traffic or protecting me from barking dogs make me feel secure.

Speaker 1 [00:13:35] Now, I will show you a scale. I will ask you to rate how much a statement reflects you. You can't read it due to the blur, but I will read it for you. My partner generally listens to me. Rate from 1 (not at all) to 9 (completely true).

Speaker 2 [00:14:21] Completely true, a 9.

Speaker 1 [00:14:25] My partner is generally sensitive to my needs. Rate from 1 to 9.

Speaker 2 [00:14:32] I would give it an 8. Everyone has their own life to focus on, so it can't always be perfect.

Speaker 1 [00:14:47] Why did you give a 9 for my partner generally listens to me?

Speaker 2 [00:14:58] I feel like he really listens to me because he remembers what I say.

Speaker 1 [00:15:11] Why did you give an 8 for my partner is generally sensitive to my needs?

Speaker 2 [00:15:21] Because sometimes life gets in the way, and we might not always be sensitive to each other's needs.

Speaker 1 [00:15:39] Why not a 7 instead of an 8?

Speaker 2 [00:15:44] Because he is very sensitive to my needs most of the time.

Speaker 1 [00:15:55] I want to learn more about your physical intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual relations these days?

Speaker 2 [00:16:10] Not very often these days. I'm comfortable with these kinds of questions, so feel free to ask.

Speaker 1 [00:16:23] How satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:16:27] We haven't been able to spend much time together lately, but generally, I'm satisfied. There are just some scheduling issues.

Speaker 1 [00:16:39] On a scale of 1 (completely dissatisfied) to 7 (completely satisfied), how satisfied are you?

Speaker 2 [00:16:53] I would say 6.

Speaker 1 [00:17:00] If it were a scale of 1 to 10, how would you rate your satisfaction?

Speaker 2 [00:17:13] A 9.

Speaker 1 [00:17:17] Why a 9?

Speaker 2 [00:17:20] Because there are times when we misunderstand each other, but overall, I've had a great experience these [1-5] years.

Speaker 1 [00:17:37] Why not an 8?

Speaker 2 [00:17:43] Because I think these [1-5] years have been truly wonderful.

Speaker 1 [00:17:56] I'm almost done. I will summarize what we talked about, and if you want to add anything, please let me know. You were middle school friends, later started interacting on social media, and your relationship is quality and healthy. Compared to past relationships, you find your current one better. Open communication and mutual respect are key. Aşk is very important to you. You prefer to talk things out rather than fight. This relationship has made you more communicative, and you believe your partner has matured. He makes you feel safe, and you are generally satisfied with your sex life. Is there anything else you'd like to add?

Speaker 2 [00:18:30] No, I don't think so.

Speaker 1: Now, before we all get together here, I want to inform you about how you will handle the data. As a research project we want to be as ethically transparent as possible and therefore want to know which data sharing option is best suited for. The first option is to share some parts without spilling our young people. It will not contain information that could identify any of these four sections. Thus, the manager will include the modified interview transcript. It can also be read by researchers. The second calculation will not pass if you don't mind and want to act a little more bravely. Is it ok? Sharing sensitive and overly descriptive details by making them searchable, that is, by making them meaningfully anonymous. However, there is a small chance that someone who knows you well will go to the same area in the [team] to narrow down the options of who they believe you are among their colleagues. I would like to reiterate that no sensitive information will be shared. Whichever you choose.